

1.

Rizal's writings have always covered how people abuse their power in his time, but in the present time, the abuse of power is still prevalent and comes in many forms. These are:

Corruption of high government officials- People with power in the government exploit it by stealing the funds that are intended for the advancement of the country

Abuse of authority by law enforcers- People who are bound by law to protect the people sometimes do the opposite by hurting civilians verbally or physically.

Political dynasties- powerful families often have very easy access to winning positions even if they are not qualified, simply because of their powerful families.

2.

Sisa lost her sanity because of losing someone very precious, her child. I think this is no doubt very hard for a mother to experience outliving her children, especially if she didn't even have the chance to say her goodbyes with him/her. This caused suffering for Sisa, which led to her being insane. I think Rizal has included this to reflect the outcomes of a chaotic society that may cause pain and suffering to many people. Even today, there will always be pain and suffering. So we should all learn empathy as we don't know how other handles pain. Every one of us has experienced pain in our lives, like losing a loved one or struggling with everyday life. So as we develop our country, we must also develop a sense of love for everybody to make our country a better place to live in, year by year.

3.

Yes, I would forgive. I do not need vengeance nor living a life full of hatred. As long as I am alive, I just want to live it, rather than worrying about other things. I would forgive her, but that doesn't mean I will get back with her because maybe we are not meant to last forever, but still, she would still have a place in my heart.

4.

I chose Sisa among the three because she had to experience the death of her children, which is very hard for a mother; that feeling of helplessness and grief will stay with her forever. Though all of them suffered tragically, Crispin was spared from further suffering because of death, while Basillio found to bounce back and take hold of his life, unlike Sisa, who, because of so much grief she went crazy.